



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archbishop McCarthy High School

School Website: <https://www.mccarthyhigh.net/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Archbishop Edward A. McCarthy High School (Southwest Ranches, FL, 33330) presents a clearly Catholic, formation-centered program with strong religious anchor points (Mass, liturgy, campus ministry, theology, sacraments) and a robust college-preparatory framework (AP courses, college advisement, Naviance, 1:1 technology). Public materials emphasize Catholic identity, character formation, and a faith-infused campus culture, alongside modern amenities (Apple Distinguished School designation, 1:1 iPad program, advanced facilities). However, the materials largely lack explicit Great Books, liberal arts Trivium/Quadrivium pedagogy, or explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy typical of classical models. The school thus sits firmly within a Catholic, college-prep tradition with some elements aligned to classical aims (formation, virtue, reverence, community), but does not fully meet the core curricular/pedagogical levers of classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Strengths: Strong religious/metaphysical foundations; explicit formation goals; faculty depicted as experienced and devoted; robust Catholic identity; active parent/community engagement; 1:1 technology and college-advisement infrastructure.
- N needles to move toward full CLASSICAL: Integrate explicit liberal arts elements (Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric in a defined Trivium framework), introduce Socratic pedagogy more consistently (especially in upper grades), and articulate a clearer Great Conversation orientation within the curriculum.
- What would move the needle: (1) Add a clearly defined classical core (grammar-logic-rhetoric, great books selections, classical history strands) and a graded Socratic/seminar program from middle school through high school; (2) incorporate more contemplative Scholé-minded days and memory/chant practices in line with classical pedagogy; (3) weave explicit language learning (Latin/Greek) and primary-source study into core courses; (4) deepen explicit Great Books reading across curricula; (5) maintain and expand strong Catholic identity while foregrounding classical educational aims in communications with parents.

Executive summary category-by-category snapshots and the detailed keyword analyses follow, grounded in the public materials and aligned to the Six Essential Elements.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]**

Evidence - Public materials describe Mass, liturgy, sacraments, a Chapel-based worship life, and daily Theology courses rooted in the Roman Catholic faith (The Theology Department; Campus Ministry; sacraments; Mass). These are repeatedly framed as central to forming students' relationship with God and living Catholic values. - Official mission and vision statements emphasize a Catholic formation of leaders, a Catholic identity, and the integration of faith with all aspects of school life (mission statements, Catholic identity emphasis, and the motto *Manere in Dilectione Christi*). - The school explicitly notes its Roman Catholic experience, Catholic identity, and liturgical practices (Mass, daily prayer, sacraments).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present from the defined lexicon: theology; liturgy; Mass; chapel; sacraments; prayer; Catholic identity; sacred music; worship; reverence; and a sacramental/worldview orientation (incarnational/sacramental). Evidence appears in multiple public materials (Theology classes; Mass in the chapel; Campus Ministry; Catholic identity statements). - Negative indicators (relativism, secular humanism, values-clarification) are not evident in the public materials reviewed. No explicit relativism signals appear.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a coherent transcendental moral framing and a theology-grounded, liturgical, and communal Catholic formation. The materials consistently place Catholic faith and practice at the center of education (theology, liturgy, sacraments, campus ministry, Mass, chapel life), meeting the Positive signals for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The presence of a formal Catholic mission and religious practices aligns with the Classical rubric's rooted-teleology and liturgical/community dimension.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Emphasis on formation: The mission states formation of tomorrow's leaders through a Roman Catholic experience; the school describes a curriculum designed to meet spiritual, cultural, and intellectual needs and to challenge students to their highest potential (formation-focused orientation). - The school frames education as a holistic formation rather than a narrow job-prep track, but it also foregrounds college readiness and advisement (college acceptance lists, Naviance, college planning). - Public materials emphasize "excellence in Atmosphere, Academics, Activities, the Arts, and Athletics," signaling a broad, human-excellence oriented telos, albeit within a Catholic context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue (explicit mentions of virtue are less visible in the public pages, but formation and moral character are implied through mission language and Catholic formation); classical mission (not explicitly labeled as such, but the formation-centric telos and human-excellence language appear in mission phrasing); wisdom (implied in academic rigor and college advisement; not always phrased as a keyword). Overall, formation/teleology is present; explicit Great Conversation/Great Books language is not. - Negative keywords present: explicit workforce-readiness or 21st-century-skills framing appears less prominent; the focus leans toward formation and Catholic identity rather than a modern, purely vocational or workforce-prep framing. The site emphasizes college advisement rather than workforce preparation, which reduces negative signals.

Why this rating - The school clearly foregrounds formation and virtue as educational telos and expresses a belief in the reality of truth, goodness, and beauty through a Catholic, formation-focused lens. However, the public materials also foreground college preparation and outcomes (AP, Naviance, college acceptances) and do not consistently articulate a comprehensive classical paideia or Great Books-based telos. While formative aims are strong, the explicit classical aims like Great Conversation or the true/good/beautiful triad as a core continuous aim are not clearly articulated across materials. This places the rating at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The curriculum is described primarily as college-preparatory with AP offerings, college advisement, and a 1:1 iPad program, rather than a classical liberal-arts core built on grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books, and Trivium/Quadrivium sequences. Public materials emphasize college-prep courses, GPA standards, and advanced placement (AP English, AP courses) rather than a Great Books-centric syllabus. - Mentions of "Great Books" or explicit classical core sequences (grammar, logic, rhetoric), as well as Latin/-Greek language study, are not evident in the public-facing materials. The emphasis remains on standard college-prep sequences, AP courses, and a technology-forward academic environment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the classical curriculum lexicon (liberal arts; trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; classical languages; history as Western civilization; Socratic texts; narration; memory work; etc.) are not clearly present in the public materials. The site highlights AP, English, mathematics, and college-advisement rather than a structured classic-core. Therefore, positive keyword presence is minimal or absent. - Negative keywords from the lexicon (social studies terminology replacing history; project-based learning dominance; STEM-first framing) are not clearly invoked as dominant framing in the public materials; however, the absence of a classical Great Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric core signals a departure from classical Curriculum norms.

Why this rating - While the school demonstrates rigorous academic preparation and a strong college-prep trajectory, its published curriculum materials do not reflect the hallmark classical elements (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; rigorous history of Western civilization; Latin/Greek in core). The absence of explicit Classical-Curriculum signals results in a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public materials emphasize modern pedagogy and structures (AP courses, college guidance, technology integration, 1:1 iPad initiative). There is no explicit, pervasive description of Socratic seminars, memory-based recitation, chanting, or other scholé practices in the public-facing materials. The presence of modern, college-prep pedagogy predominates. - There are some references to collaborative activities (speech & debate; drama; arts) and student-centered programs, but explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, recitation, disciplined routine of classical pedagogy) are not clearly advertised. - The school's pedagogical approach includes a focus on technology integration (iPads) and college advisement, with an emphasis on academic achievement and a standard college-prep culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the pedagogy lexicon (Socratic seminar; dialectic; disputation; narration; recitation; chanting; memory work; scholé; contemplative/restful learning) are not clearly present in the public materials. - Negative keywords (experiential learning focus; project-based only; student-directed; constructivist) are not explicitly claimed; however, the absence of classical pedagogical signals yields a leaning away from classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The overall pedagogy described is modern, college-prep oriented with technology and advisory supports. There is no explicit mention of the core classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, memory work, chant, recitation, or scholé). This supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Text highlights a faculty described as highly qualified, with degrees and years of experience, and dedicated to student development. There are explicit notes that faculty are passionate about students, and that they form part of a "living curriculum" and a "faculty of friends" or a "portrait of what a teacher should be." - The school emphasizes a strong Catholic identity through its faculty and recognitions (Catholic Education Honor Roll; Apple Distinguished School), underscoring a culture where teachers model virtue and knowledge. - The presence of awards and recognitions (Apple Distinguished School) and ongoing professional development is highlighted (faculty professional development; teacher experience).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; professional development; moral exemplars; living curriculum; teachers with degrees and years of experience; Apple Distinguished School; Catholic identity in education. These align with the classical (positive signals around the faculty as living curriculum and moral exemplars). - Negative keywords (from the lexicon) suggesting a weak classical faculty profile (e.g., "facilitators on the side" or "certification-driven" without classical context) are not evident; the public materials present a strong, engaged faculty narrative.

Why this rating - The school presents a defined, virtuous, and engaged faculty culture with explicit language about teachers as living curriculum and moral exemplars. This aligns well with the Classical rubric's expectations for model teachers, mentors, and a living curriculum, meriting CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers and a strong parental role in formation, attendance at information nights, and involvement in the school's programs. The Parent Services, opportunities for parent education, and open-campus ethos are described, including events, family liturgy, and parental involvement. - The materials describe programs that educate parents and involve them in book studies, seminars, and other formation activities, signaling a deliberate parental formation and partnership model. - There is emphasis on welcoming parents for visits and involvement in the school's life, including community service, parent conferences, and multiple opportunities for family engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; family liturgy alignment. - Negative keywords present: consumer-language signals (not clearly evident in the public materials); no explicit negative signals about parent involvement. - The lexicon's signals for Parents & Community emphasize active parental participation and formation; the school materials align with these signals.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a robust, classical-friendly pattern of parent engagement and community partnership, including parental formation and opportunities for involvement. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curricular enrichment: Introduce a clearly articulated classical core (grammar-logic-rhetoric) and a defined Great Books program with a fall-spring reading sequence and accompanying seminars from middle school through high school.
 - Pedagogical shift: Implement regular Socratic seminars, memory-work traditions, and chant/narration practices where appropriate to cultivate the classical discipline of mind and memory.
 - Language and primary sources: Integrate Latin (or Greek) as a core language offering at least in foundational levels, with primary-source history/literature to support a "Great Conversation" approach.
 - History and humanities emphasis: Reframe history as a Western civilization-centered liberal arts discipline with primary-source readings and interpretive writing; clearly distinguish history from social studies.
 - Explicit articulation of telos: Emphasize the classical telos (true, good, beautiful) as an educational aim beyond college-prep outcomes in mission statements and program documentation.
 - Faculty development: Expand formal classical pedagogy training and create living-syllabus exemplars for teachers, plus faculty seminars on classical teaching methods.
 - Communication with families: Increase explicit, public-facing documentation of the classical elements (e.g., a classical-aim policy, curriculum maps, and reading lists) to help parents understand how classical education is integrated with the Catholic mission.
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.